

GED Social Studies Practice Test 15

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC15-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires lawmakers to identify a stable funding source before creating a new program that must operate every year. A bill may not rely only on one-time money, such as a temporary grant or a budget surplus, if the program will require ongoing staff, offices, and services.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this requirement?

- A) Encouraging lawmakers to match ongoing programs with ongoing revenue
- B) Allowing courts to spend public money without approval
- C) Preventing the state from creating any public program
- D) Giving private donors control over state law

GED-SOC15-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A town compares the effect of two tax options on different households.

Household type: Renter with low income, Homeowner with high income

Annual sales tax paid under Option A: \$420, \$1,150

Annual property tax paid under Option B: \$0, \$2,400

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Option A affects both household types, while Option B directly affects only the homeowner listed.
- B) Option B directly affects the renter more than the homeowner.
- C) Option A and Option B have identical effects on both households.
- D) The renter pays more under Option B than under Option A.

GED-SOC15-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the late 1800s, many African American teachers and community leaders built schools in rural areas despite limited public funding and segregation. Churches, mutual-aid groups, and families often raised money for books, buildings, and teacher salaries. These efforts showed that education was viewed as a path to citizenship, independence, and community strength.

Which conclusion is best supported by the source?

- A) Community-led education efforts helped respond to unequal public resources.
- B) Segregation guaranteed equal school funding in every community.
- C) African American communities avoided building educational institutions.
- D) Rural education had no connection to citizenship or opportunity.

GED-SOC15-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A described map shows a country with three main regions. The northern region has forests and rivers used for timber and hydropower. The central region has dry grasslands used for cattle grazing. The southern region has a deep-water port and factories that assemble imported parts into finished goods.

Which statement best explains the pattern shown on the described map?

- A) Different physical features and trade access support different regional economies.
- B) All regions must have the same economic activities.
- C) Deep-water ports prevent manufacturing.
- D) Forests and rivers have no connection to economic activity.

GED-SOC15-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state creates a formula for distributing school aid. The formula gives extra weight to districts with high transportation costs, many English learners, or low local tax capacity. Some wealthy districts argue that all students should receive the same dollar amount.

Which TWO statements best explain the civic issue in this situation?

- A) Funding formulas can reflect different ideas about equal treatment and student need.
- B) Local tax capacity can affect how much help a district may require from the state.
- C) School aid formulas are unrelated to public policy.
- D) Wealthy districts always receive less money because courts write school budgets.
- E) English learners cannot be considered when states design education policy.

GED-SOC15-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A federal official argues that national rules are needed for freight trains carrying hazardous

chemicals because rail lines cross many state borders. The official says a single safety standard helps companies and emergency planners understand the same rules in every state.

Source B:

A state emergency manager argues that states should be able to add stricter requirements for trains passing near dense neighborhoods or major rivers. The manager says local risks differ, and state officials may know which routes require extra planning.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether rail safety rules should be nationally uniform or allow stricter state protections
- B) Whether trains should be replaced by state courts
- C) Whether states may issue their own national currency
- D) Whether emergency managers should control foreign policy

GED-SOC15-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During World War I, many women worked in offices, factories, farms, and volunteer organizations that supported the war effort. Some suffrage supporters argued that women's public contributions showed they deserved full political rights. Opponents still claimed that politics should remain a male responsibility.

Which historical issue is most clearly reflected in this source?

- A) Wartime service strengthened arguments for women's suffrage.
- B) Women stopped participating in public life during World War I.
- C) Suffrage debates ended before the war began.
- D) World War I had no connection to political rights debates.

GED-SOC15-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

When the national government sets a minimum rule that states may exceed but not go below, it creates [D1]. When the national government completely blocks conflicting state rules, it uses [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) a federal floor | a private contract | a jury verdict

D2) preemption | naturalization | reapportionment

GED-SOC15-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A business takes a short-term loan of \$12,000 at a simple annual interest rate of 5%. How many

dollars of interest will the business owe after one year?
Type your answer as a dollar amount without the dollar sign.

GED-SOC15-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A small island country imports most of its fuel and food. When shipping costs rise, household prices increase quickly. The government considers investing in solar power, local agriculture, and port storage facilities.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Dependence on imported essentials can make a country vulnerable to transportation costs.
- B) Island countries cannot participate in global trade.
- C) Higher shipping costs reduce all household prices.
- D) Local energy production always increases dependence on imported fuel.

GED-SOC15-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state law requires regional planning councils to include representatives from cities, counties, and tribal governments when planning wildfire evacuation routes. The routes cross several jurisdictions, including reservation lands and county roads.

Which civic issue is most clearly shown?

- A) Coordinating public safety planning across overlapping governments
- B) Allowing one county to control all tribal land
- C) Replacing emergency planning with private contracts only
- D) Giving regional councils power to appoint federal judges

GED-SOC15-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows participation in one adult literacy program.

Year: 1925, 1940, 1960

Participants: 2,400, 6,800, 15,200

Volunteer instructors: 80, 190, 310

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Participants increased more sharply than volunteer instructors.
- B) Volunteer instructors decreased after 1925.

- C) Participants were lowest in 1960.
- D) Participants and instructors stayed the same over time.

GED-SOC15-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution allows the legislature to create special courts for limited subjects, such as tax disputes or workers' compensation appeals. These courts may hear only the types of cases listed in the law that created them.

Which statement best describes this arrangement?

- A) Specialized courts may be created with limited legal authority.
- B) Special courts may hear every type of case without limits.
- C) Private companies may create courts without lawmaking authority.
- D) Specialized courts replace all state and federal courts.

GED-SOC15-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A city considers replacing a flat vehicle registration fee with a mileage-based road fee. Supporters say people who drive more miles would pay more toward road upkeep. Critics say rural residents may drive longer distances because they have fewer nearby services.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this scenario?

- A) A fee structure can shift costs based on how much people use a service.
- B) Geography can affect how a transportation fee impacts different residents.
- C) Mileage-based fees cannot affect household costs.
- D) Rural residents always drive fewer miles than urban residents.
- E) Road funding has no connection to public finance.

GED-SOC15-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A city wants to regulate delivery robots on sidewalks. State law already allows the devices but permits cities to set rules for sidewalk speed, hours of operation, and blocked pathways. A city ordinance bans the devices entirely.

Which statement best explains the likely legal conflict?

- A) The city ban may conflict with the limited local authority allowed by state law.

- B) Cities always have unlimited authority to ban any technology.
- C) State law cannot affect sidewalk rules.
- D) Delivery devices are regulated only by foreign governments.

GED-SOC15-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

In the early twentieth century, African American newspapers reported on lynching, segregation, business achievements, church life, and migration opportunities. These papers often encouraged political action and helped readers compare conditions in different regions.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Black newspapers helped share information and support political awareness.
- B) Newspapers could connect local experiences to broader regional and national issues.
- C) Black newspapers avoided all discussion of migration and civil rights.
- D) Newspapers had no role in shaping public opinion.
- E) Segregation prevented all printed communication.

GED-SOC15-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country compares export destinations.

Destination: Neighboring countries, Regional trade bloc, Distant overseas markets

Export value: \$18 billion, \$44 billion, \$28 billion

Average shipping time: 2 days, 5 days, 21 days

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) The regional trade bloc receives the highest export value, while distant overseas markets have the longest shipping time.
- B) Neighboring countries receive the highest export value and have the longest shipping time.
- C) Distant overseas markets receive no exports.
- D) All destinations have the same shipping time.

GED-SOC15-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state creates a hospital reimbursement formula that pays more to rural hospitals with emergency rooms because those hospitals must stay open even when they serve fewer patients. Urban hospitals argue that they treat more total patients and should receive more money.

Which issue is most clearly shown?

- A) Funding formulas may weigh access, volume, and regional needs differently.
- B) Rural hospitals cannot receive public funding.
- C) Urban hospitals are not part of health policy.
- D) Reimbursement formulas have no connection to public services.

GED-SOC15-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A county compares two broadband expansion bids.

Bid: A, B

Homes reached: 8,000, 11,000

Public cost: \$4 million, \$7.7 million

Completion time: 18 months, 12 months

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Bid B reaches more homes and finishes sooner, but it has the higher public cost.
- B) Bid A reaches more homes than Bid B.
- C) Bid A has the higher public cost and the shorter completion time.
- D) Both bids reach the same number of homes.

GED-SOC15-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The growth of Spanish-language radio, newspapers, and television in the late twentieth century reflected [D1] and helped communities maintain [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) changing immigration and cultural patterns | early colonial mercantilism | Civil War battlefield tactics

D2) language, news, and cultural connections | plantation labor systems | western land surveys

GED-SOC15-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state infrastructure fund has \$75 million. It awards \$18 million for dams, \$22 million for ports, and \$16 million for rural broadband.

How much money remains in the fund?

- A) \$19 million
- B) \$22 million

- C) \$56 million
- D) \$75 million

GED-SOC15-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state requires cities that receive housing grants to report how many units were built, how many were affordable to low-income households, and how much local money was contributed. The state does not choose the exact building sites, but it uses the reports to evaluate whether grant goals are being met.

Which statement best describes this relationship?

- A) The state uses reporting requirements to monitor grant outcomes while leaving some local control.
- B) Cities may spend housing grants without reporting results.
- C) State grants eliminate all local decision-making.
- D) Housing grants are unrelated to public accountability.

GED-SOC15-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A mountain tunnel reduces a freight route from 310 miles to 245 miles. How many miles shorter is the route with the tunnel?

Type your answer as a whole number.

GED-SOC15-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the late twentieth century, many Native nations expanded tribal colleges, language programs, health clinics, and cultural centers. These institutions supported education and services while strengthening self-government and cultural renewal.

Which broader historical pattern is shown by the source?

- A) Native institutions supported self-determination and cultural preservation.
- B) Native nations lost all ability to create educational institutions.
- C) Cultural programs prevented tribal governments from providing services.
- D) Health clinics had no connection to community development.

GED-SOC15-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

A) Federal floor

B) Specialized court

C) Mileage-based fee

D) Reimbursement formula

Targets:

T1) A minimum national standard that states may exceed

T2) A court with authority limited to certain types of cases

T3) A payment method that distributes money according to listed factors

GED-SOC15-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A manufacturer keeps extra inventory of a critical computer chip after earlier shipping delays stopped production. Holding extra inventory costs money, but the company says the expense is worth reducing the risk of another shutdown.

Which economic idea is most clearly shown?

A) Businesses may accept higher inventory costs to reduce supply disruption risk.

B) Inventory has no relationship to production.

C) Supply delays always lower business costs.

D) Manufacturers cannot adjust after supply-chain problems.

GED-SOC15-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state constitution says revenue from a lottery must be deposited into an education fund.

Lawmakers may use the fund for school materials, early childhood programs, and student support services, but not for unrelated highway projects.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this rule?

A) Dedicating a revenue source to a specific public purpose

B) Allowing lottery revenue to be spent on any private project

C) Preventing public education from receiving state funds

D) Giving courts power to run lottery drawings

GED-SOC15-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A state court rules that a city may require permits for large street festivals to manage sanitation and emergency access. However, the permit fee must be related to the actual cost of providing city services and may not be used as a hidden tax.

Which conclusion is best supported by the ruling?

- A) Local fees may be valid when tied to the cost of public services provided.
- B) Cities may charge any fee without explaining its purpose.
- C) Festivals cannot be regulated for public safety.
- D) Courts cannot review local fee systems.

GED-SOC15-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A described map shows a desert region with lithium deposits, a nearby solar-energy zone, and a rail connection to a coastal battery factory. New towns are growing near the rail line, but water planners warn that mining and population growth may strain underground water.

Which conclusion is best supported by the described map?

- A) Resource development can link energy industries, transportation, settlement, and water stress.
- B) Desert resources never attract settlement or industry.
- C) Rail connections prevent factories from using minerals.
- D) Underground water is unrelated to mining communities.

GED-SOC15-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state grant program awards points to project applications.

Criterion: Low-income area, Regional cooperation, Local matching funds, Climate resilience

Maximum points: 30, 20, 25, 25

Project score: 24, 12, 20, 18

How many total points did the project receive?

- A) 62
- B) 70
- C) 74
- D) 100

GED-SOC15-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state allows counties to share tax revenue from a new industrial park if the park uses roads, utilities, and workers from more than one county. The agreement must be approved by each county's governing board.

Which civic purpose is most directly supported by this arrangement?

- A) Sharing costs and benefits when economic development crosses local boundaries
- B) Allowing one county to collect taxes for private use only
- C) Giving industrial parks authority to replace county boards
- D) Preventing local governments from cooperating

GED-SOC15-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state compares proposed flood-control projects.

Project: Levee upgrade, Wetland restoration, Pump station

Cost: \$30 million, \$18 million, \$24 million

Homes protected: 9,000, 5,400, 4,800

Annual maintenance: \$2 million, \$0.6 million, \$1.8 million

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) The levee upgrade protects the most homes.
- B) Wetland restoration has the lowest annual maintenance cost.
- C) The pump station costs less than wetland restoration.
- D) Wetland restoration protects more homes than the levee upgrade.
- E) The levee upgrade has the lowest annual maintenance cost.

GED-SOC15-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A described map shows fiber-optic cables connecting coastal landing stations to inland technology centers. Cities near the landing stations have developed data centers, repair services, and training programs for network technicians.

Which conclusion is best supported by the described map?

- A) Digital infrastructure can influence the location of jobs and services.
- B) Fiber-optic cables are unrelated to economic geography.
- C) Technology jobs can exist only in farming regions.
- D) Coastal landing stations prevent inland connections.

GED-SOC15-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows changes in U.S. household communication access.

Year: 1980, 2000, 2020

Landline phone: 92%, 94%, 38%

Internet access: 0%, 41%, 89%

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Internet access rose sharply while landline phone access declined by 2020.
- B) Landline phone access increased sharply from 2000 to 2020.
- C) Internet access was highest in 1980.
- D) Both forms of access stayed exactly the same over time.

GED-SOC15-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires that money collected from pollution penalties be used for environmental cleanup or restoration projects. Lawmakers may not use the money for unrelated programs unless voters approve a constitutional change.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Penalty revenue can be restricted to a related public purpose.
- B) Pollution penalties must be used only for private gifts.
- C) Environmental cleanup cannot be funded by public money.
- D) Voters have no role in changing constitutional spending rules.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC15-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Encouraging lawmakers to match ongoing programs with ongoing revenue — Explanation: The rule prevents long-term programs from relying only on temporary funding sources.

GED-SOC15-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Option A affects both household types, while Option B directly affects only the homeowner listed. — Explanation: Both households pay sales tax under Option A, while only the homeowner listed pays property tax under Option B.

GED-SOC15-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Community-led education efforts helped respond to unequal public resources. — Explanation: The source shows churches, families, and mutual-aid groups supporting schools despite segregation and limited funding.

GED-SOC15-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Different physical features and trade access support different regional economies. — Explanation: Forests, grasslands, and port access support different economic activities.

GED-SOC15-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Funding formulas can reflect different ideas about equal treatment and student need. | Local tax capacity can affect how much help a district may require from the state. — Explanation: The formula weights student and district needs, while the dispute reflects different views of fairness.

GED-SOC15-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether rail safety rules should be nationally uniform or allow stricter state protections — Explanation: Source A supports one national rule, while Source B argues for stricter state rules based on local risks.

GED-SOC15-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Wartime service strengthened arguments for women's suffrage. — Explanation: The source links women's wartime contributions to claims for full political rights.

GED-SOC15-008 — Correct: D1=a federal floor; D2=preemption — Correct Answer: D1=a federal floor; D2=preemption — Explanation: A federal floor sets a minimum standard, while preemption blocks conflicting state rules.

GED-SOC15-009 — Correct: 600 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 600 — Explanation: Simple interest is $\$12,000 \times 0.05 \times 1 = \600 .

GED-SOC15-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Dependence on imported essentials can make a country vulnerable to transportation costs. — Explanation: Fuel and food imports become more expensive when shipping costs rise.

GED-SOC15-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Coordinating public safety planning across overlapping governments — Explanation: Wildfire evacuation planning crosses city, county, and tribal jurisdictions.

GED-SOC15-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Participants increased more sharply than volunteer instructors. — Explanation: Participants rose from 2,400 to 15,200, while instructors rose from 80 to 310.

GED-SOC15-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Specialized courts may be created with limited legal authority. — Explanation: The courts may hear only the types of cases listed in the law.

GED-SOC15-014 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: A fee structure can shift costs based on how much people use a service. | Geography can affect how a transportation fee impacts different residents. — Explanation: A mileage fee charges more to those who drive more, but rural residents may need to drive farther.

GED-SOC15-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The city ban may conflict with the limited local authority allowed by state law. — Explanation: State law allows cities to regulate certain details, but a total ban may exceed that authority.

GED-SOC15-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Black newspapers helped share information and support political awareness. | Newspapers could connect local experiences to broader regional and national issues. — Explanation: The papers reported on civil rights, migration, business, and community life.

GED-SOC15-017 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The regional trade bloc receives the highest export value, while distant overseas markets have the longest shipping time. — Explanation: The

regional trade bloc receives \$44 billion, and overseas markets have the longest shipping time at 21 days.

GED-SOC15-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Funding formulas may weigh access, volume, and regional needs differently. — Explanation: The formula values rural access, while urban hospitals emphasize patient volume.

GED-SOC15-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Bid B reaches more homes and finishes sooner, but it has the higher public cost. — Explanation: Bid B reaches 11,000 homes and finishes in 12 months, but costs \$7.7 million.

GED-SOC15-020 — Correct: D1=changing immigration and cultural patterns; D2=language, news, and cultural connections — Correct Answer: D1=changing immigration and cultural patterns; D2=language, news, and cultural connections — Explanation: Spanish-language media reflected demographic change and helped communities maintain information and cultural ties.

GED-SOC15-021 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: \$19 million — Explanation: \$18 million + \$22 million + \$16 million = \$56 million spent; \$75 million – \$56 million = \$19 million remaining.

GED-SOC15-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The state uses reporting requirements to monitor grant outcomes while leaving some local control. — Explanation: Cities report results but still choose specific local building sites.

GED-SOC15-023 — Correct: 65 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 65 — Explanation: 310 miles minus 245 miles equals 65 miles.

GED-SOC15-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Native institutions supported self-determination and cultural preservation. — Explanation: Tribal colleges, language programs, clinics, and cultural centers support services, self-government, and culture.

GED-SOC15-025 — Correct: T1=A; T2=B; T3=D — Correct Answer: T1=Federal floor; T2=Specialized court; T3=Reimbursement formula — Explanation: A federal floor is a minimum national standard, specialized courts have limited case authority, and reimbursement formulas distribute payments by factors.

GED-SOC15-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Businesses may accept higher inventory costs to reduce supply disruption risk. — Explanation: Extra inventory costs money but helps prevent production shutdowns.

GED-SOC15-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Dedicating a revenue source to a specific public purpose — Explanation: Lottery revenue is restricted to education-related uses.

GED-SOC15-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Local fees may be valid when tied to the cost of public services provided. — Explanation: The permit fee must relate to sanitation, emergency access, and other service costs.

GED-SOC15-029 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Resource development can link energy industries, transportation, settlement, and water stress. — Explanation: Lithium, solar energy, rail, factories, town growth, and groundwater concerns are connected in the scenario.

GED-SOC15-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 74 — Explanation: $24 + 12 + 20 + 18 = 74$ points.

GED-SOC15-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Sharing costs and benefits when economic development crosses local boundaries — Explanation: The industrial park uses resources from more than one county, so the counties share revenue by agreement.

GED-SOC15-032 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: The levee upgrade protects the most homes. | Wetland restoration has the lowest annual maintenance cost. — Explanation: The levee protects 9,000 homes, and wetland restoration has the lowest maintenance cost at \$0.6 million.

GED-SOC15-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Digital infrastructure can influence the location of jobs and services. — Explanation: Cable landing stations are linked to data centers, repair services, and training programs.

GED-SOC15-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Internet access rose sharply while landline phone access declined by 2020. — Explanation: Internet access increased from 0% to 89%, while landline access fell from 94% in 2000 to 38% in 2020.

GED-SOC15-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Penalty revenue can be restricted to a related public purpose. — Explanation: Pollution penalties are restricted to cleanup or restoration unless the constitutional rule is changed.